Alroy Ndhlovu

Product Management & UX Design · Marketing & Brand Strategy · AI-Native Product Builder

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product, brand and marketing lead with 12+ years taking products from idea to market. Built and launched four products in 2026, writing the specification, choosing the stack and directing coding agents such as Claude Code: InSpiritInTruth, a devotional app with 131 monthly active users, its first paying subscribers and a 5.0 App Store rating; tapa., a recipe app; CaughtSlipping, a Chrome extension with 183 installs; and Hakkan, an AI research tool. Led Social Sweep at Innovatr from the build-versus-buy case to launch and upkeep, replacing a US$5,000-a-year licence; it now sells in every Innovatr membership. Earlier ran e-commerce end to end at Reka Afrika and iBags: suppliers, product range, presentation and the online store. Brings the go-to-market depth product teams usually hire in: positioning, paid acquisition at roughly three times better cost per lead than the B2B median, and CRM and marketing automation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product & UX: Product management · Product range management · E-commerce merchandising · Product marketing · Product positioning · Product design · UX/UI design · User experience design · User research · Discovery · Information architecture · Wireframing · Prototyping · Design systems · Usability testing · Responsive design · Accessibility (WCAG) · Roadmapping · Agile project management · Pricing strategy · Mobile app development · SaaS product development

Marketing & Growth: Marketing strategy · Go-to-market strategy · Integrated campaigns · Performance marketing · Paid media · Paid social · Paid search · Meta Ads · Google Ads · LinkedIn Ads · TikTok Ads · Demand generation · Account-based marketing (ABM) · Lead generation · Conversion rate optimisation (CRO) · A/B testing · Search engine optimisation (SEO) · Email marketing · CRM and marketing automation · Marketing analytics · Return on ad spend (ROAS) · Cost per lead (CPL) · Customer acquisition · E-commerce strategy · Social media marketing · Community management

Brand & Creative: Brand strategy · Brand positioning · Brand identity · Brand voice · Visual identity · Brand guidelines · Brand storytelling · Rebranding · Corporate branding · Creative direction · Art direction · Content strategy · Copywriting · Graphic design · Packaging design · Photography · Video production · Motion design

Business Technology, Automation & AI: Business technology consulting · Digital transformation · Business process automation · Workflow automation · No-code and low-code automation · Systems integration · API integration · CMS implementation · E-commerce platform builds · AI-native product development · AI-assisted (vibe) coding · Directing coding agents · Technical specification · Stack selection · Rapid prototyping · AI workflow design · Agentic workflows · Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) · Prompt engineering · Multimodal input (vision and voice) · Model evaluation and grounding · Citation verification · Hallucination mitigation · Human-in-the-loop review · Cloud computing · Data analysis · Privacy-by-design

Consulting & Enablement: Stakeholder management · Client consulting · Training delivery · Curriculum development · E-learning implementation · Workshop facilitation · Public speaking · Cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Brand, Product & Marketing Consultant

Independent · Self-employed · 2018 – Present · Johannesburg, South Africa · Hybrid

Consulting across brand, product and marketing.

- Built and launched four products end to end: InSpiritInTruth and tapa. (mobile apps), CaughtSlipping (Chrome extension) and Hakkan (AI research tool, in beta), alongside Social Sweep for Innovatr.
- Delivered brand strategy, content strategy, integrated campaigns, marketing optimisation and business process automation for clients including Total Sports, Jenna Clifford, Cash'n'Sport and Nembhard Inc, alongside the contracts listed below.
- Art-directed content for Jenna Clifford, made the event video for the IAB Bookmark Awards, made Total Sports' staff training video on fitting running shoes end to end, and delivered training for iHub.
- Trained and advised 1,200+ people, mainly through Meta's programmes with Digify Africa and the IFC, and served 25+ businesses as clients.

- Delivered the LumiSkin brand site, covering concept, AI production, front-end and motion, in a single day for under $300, against $6,500+ quoted for the same brief produced conventionally.
- Founded and run Filosofee, a South African streetwear label: designed the range, built the e-commerce store, integrated payments, art-directed the shoot and ran the go-to-market. Sold locally and internationally in its first month and landed a 20-unit wholesale order from another brand.

Brand & Marketing Manager and Product Lead (Social Sweep)

Innovatr · Full-time · Mar 2026 – Sep 2026 · Johannesburg, South Africa · Hybrid

Consumer intelligence platform; clients include Discovery Bank, DGB, Namibian Breweries and Rain.

- Product lead for Social Sweep, a proprietary AI social listening product: made the build-versus-buy case, then planned, built and maintained it. Replaced a US$5,000-a-year licence with an in-house build under R10,000; it now sells in every Innovatr membership.
- Owned digital marketing end to end. Ran LinkedIn Ads with account-based marketing (ABM): 61% of delivery reached decision-makers, at a third of the B2B median cost per lead (CPL).
- Built the CRM from nothing and the marketing automation behind it, then wrote and designed every email sequence in Zoho Campaigns: 36.7% opens and 4.1% clicks on onboarding, against typical B2B rates of 30–35% and 2.5%.
- Ran social media and content marketing, turning proprietary research into LinkedIn carousels, video and ad creative; the same message as video drew 0.68% click-through against 0.24% as a carousel.
- Led the rebrand with the founder (positioning, visual identity and go-to-market strategy), wrote the brand guidelines, produced the brand assets, and redesigned and maintained the company website.

Digital Marketing Consultant

Thrifty Adventures · Contract · Jul 2025 – Mar 2026 · Remote

Travel operator running group and tailored tours out of South Africa.

- Owned marketing strategy and paid media across four channels, plus brand strategy, content design, e-commerce strategy and business development, taking the brand from scattered to deliberate.
- Lifted lead-form conversion rate to 36.6% against a 10–15% LinkedIn benchmark; the brochure offer went on to drive 73% of all leads, while cost per lead on everything else ran 39% higher.
- Grew TikTok to 3.1 million organic views from the existing account, with paid click-through at 0.97% against a 0.52% platform median.
- Restructured the paid account through creative and audience A/B testing, cutting cost per click 58% month on month, lifting reach roughly eight-fold in the first month and holding it through the scale-up.

Web Design Specialist

Deep Ocean · Freelance · Oct 2024 – Oct 2025 · Remote

- Designed and built the website for Deep Ocean Integrated Solutions, an Angolan oil and gas services company (deepocean.solutions), then ran its business email, domains and maintenance.

Web Design Specialist

English Plus Academy · Contract · Oct 2024 – Mar 2025 · Remote

- Redesigned the academy's website and migrated its hosting to a provider able to carry planned growth, then stayed on call for web development and business technology support.

Digital Marketing Consultant

African Agri Council · Contract · Aug 2024 – Nov 2024 · South Africa · Remote

African Agri Council NPC and its African Agri Investment Indaba event.

- Owned digital marketing strategy and delivery for the council and its flagship investment Indaba.
- Formulated paid media and content strategy across Facebook, LinkedIn and Google, built CRM automation and lead-capture workflows, and ran campaign data analysis that fed each successive round of optimisation.

Social Media Specialist

Eris Property Group · Freelance · Aug 2024 · South Africa · Remote

- Agency-side, multi-brand social media for five shopping centres on a short-term support contract: created posts for more than twenty tenant brands (Pick n Pay, Pep, Debonairs, local pharmacies and butchers) within each one's identity, and ran community management, occasional paid boosts and reporting.

Digital Media & Marketing Consultant

Energy Capital & Power · Contract · Nov 2023 – Mar 2024 · Remote

- Designed and delivered PR and digital marketing training programmes for delegates of the Minister of Mines and Hydrocarbons, Equatorial Guinea.
- Consulted on and ran campaign support for the company's flagship multinational annual events: content direction and creation, campaign build and management across LinkedIn, Google Ads and Facebook, and periodic reporting.

Brand & Social Media Management

Kelly-Ann Mealia · Freelance · Sep 2022 – Apr 2024

Co-founder and Chairperson of Energy Capital & Power.

- Managed her LinkedIn personal brand: created the content, produced video and photography, and managed her community.

Digital Marketing Consultant

IFC (World Bank Group) · Contract · May 2022 – Oct 2023

The We Are Victoria Falls programme, sponsored by the IFC in partnership with Zimbabwe Tourism, helping tourism SMEs recover after COVID.

- Developed the digital marketing curriculum and content for roughly 50 tourism SMEs across the programme, published on its training site, wearevictoriafalls.com.
- Delivered one-on-one consulting to around 20 businesses selected for additional support, equipping them with the tools to rebuild demand.

Meta Certified Lead Trainer & Consultant

Digify Africa · Contract · Jul 2020 – Nov 2022 · South Africa

Meta's training delivery partner in Africa. Four positions over two and a half years, from assistant lead to programme lead.

> **Digify Pro Lead Trainer** Jun 2022 – Aug 2022
>
> - Training lead for the Digify Pro programme covering digital marketing, social media and entrepreneurship, with particular emphasis on Meta properties, having served as assistant lead the previous year.
>
> **Facebook Diaspora Workshop Lead** Nov 2021
>
> - Developed and delivered the full curriculum for the Facebook Diaspora Workshop, supporting 20+ UK-based diaspora businesses.
>
> **Digify Pro Assistant Lead** Jun 2021 – Sep 2021
>
> - Assistant lead on the Digify Pro programme, before stepping up to lead it the following year.
>
> **Boost with Facebook Trainer** Jul 2020 – Nov 2022
>
> - Facilitated and delivered training on Meta's suite of products to over 1,000 people, including SMEs, digital marketing students and independent operators.

Product, Marketing & E-Commerce Manager

Reka Afrika · Full-time · Jul 2017 – Oct 2018

- Ran e-commerce end to end: sourced suppliers, chose and maintained the product range, photographed and marketed the products, and built the website and online store.

E-Commerce & Product Manager

iBags.co.za · Full-time · Apr 2013 – Jun 2017

- Ran e-commerce end to end for four years: sourced suppliers, chose and maintained the product range, kept the website and product presentation current, and worked with the agency that ran marketing.

PRODUCTS SHIPPED

InSpiritInTruth Faith & Devotion · iOS and Android · Live · specified and shipped solo, AI-native

Retrieval-grounded generation against a fixed scripture corpus, with a verification pass taking ~77% of the AI effort, because an app that quotes scripture cannot afford to misquote it. Live on the App Store: 131 monthly active users, two paying subscribers in its first two months, 5.0 rating.

React Native · Expo 57 · TypeScript · Expo Router · NativeWind · Supabase · TanStack Query · Reanimated + Skia · RevenueCat · Claude Code

https://apps.apple.com/app/inspiritintruth-devotional/id6795657774

tapa. Food & Cooking · iOS and Android · Live · specified and shipped solo, AI-native

Multimodal input (text, voice and vision) resolved into a single constrained generation, with dietary rules set once and enforced as hard constraints rather than prompt suggestions. Offline-first. Live on the App Store: 47 monthly active users.

React Native · Expo 57 · TypeScript · NativeWind · Supabase · SQLite offline cache · Zustand · Vision + voice input · RevenueCat · Claude Code

https://apps.apple.com/app/tapa-cook-what-you-hav3d6795631556

CaughtSlipping Focus & Productivity · Chrome extension · Live · specified and shipped solo, AI-native

Local-first behavioural tracking with no account and no server: everything stays on the device. Chrome Web Store: 183 installs and one uninstall in six months.

Manifest V3 · Vanilla JS, no framework · Service worker · declarativeNetRequest · Offscreen documents · chrome.storage, local only · Chart.js · Claude Code

https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/ncepfdipljmhbhehjegfemndcgaclnlg

Hakkan Content Research & Development · Web · Beta · specified and shipped solo, AI-native

Specified and directed an agentic research pipeline: multi-platform retrieval synthesised into a cited, source-grounded report, then generation in the user's own learned voice. Rebuilding the evidence filter took verified human sources from 29% of citations to 57%; anything the model inferred is flagged rather than hidden.

Next.js 16 · React 19 · TypeScript · Tailwind v4 · Supabase · Vercel AI SDK · Claude + Grok · Paddle · Recharts · Sentry · Claude Code

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

AI & Cybersecurity Technology Certifications Google, Codecademy, CISCO Networking Academy · 2025 – Ongoing

Full-Stack Web Development App Brewery · 2026 – Current

Professional Certificate in Digital Marketing University of Maryland (EdX) · Completed Jun 2025

Professional Certificate in Product Management University of Maryland (EdX) · Completed Dec 2025

Cloud Computing & AI Google Cloud, Codecademy · 2024 – 2025

UX/UI & Design Interaction Design Foundation, UXCEL · 2023 – 2024

Digital Marketing Shaw Academy, Meta, Google, LinkedIn and others · 2019 – 2023

Tourism Management Oxbridge Academy · 2022 – 2023

Film & Photography Studies Lights Film School, Photography Institute · 2017 – 2018

Graphic Design Specialisation CalArts (Coursera) · 2016 – 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

Platforms & CMS (hands-on): WordPress · WooCommerce · Shopify · Squarespace · Webflow

Marketing & analytics: Meta Ads Manager · Google Ads · LinkedIn Campaign Manager · TikTok Ads Manager · Google Analytics 4 · Google Tag Manager · Google Search Console · Zoho Campaigns · HubSpot · Mailchimp · Paddle · RevenueCat

Design, product & delivery: Figma · Affinity Designer · Adobe Creative Suite · Canva · Notion · Airtable · Linear · Jira · Asana · Trello · Miro · Slack

AI & automation: Claude · Claude Code · OpenAI Codex · Google Gemini · Grok · Vercel AI SDK · Zapier · Make · n8n · Model Context Protocol (MCP)

Product stacks (specified and directed; built with coding agents, not hand-written): TypeScript · React · React Native · Expo · Next.js · Astro · Tailwind CSS · Supabase · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Chrome Manifest V3 · Vercel · Netlify · Git